

STAGE TWO • PROFESSIONAL IDENTITY & PERSONAL BRAND

FIRSTS

FAQ

Anticipated participant questions and suggested facilitator responses

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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PURPOSE

These are the questions that come up most often across cohorts of Stage Two, with a suggested facilitator response for each. Use these as a starting point, not a rigid script.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. What if I genuinely don't have a personal brand yet, or don't know what it should be?

A: That's exactly what this stage is for — no one arrives with a fully formed brand. Start from FIRST B1 through B6 honestly, even if the answers feel rough, and let the later exercises sharpen them. A brand statement doesn't need to be permanent; it needs to be true right now.

Q2. Do I have to be active on social media to complete this stage?

A: No. Several exercises (B28–B34) ask you to find your own sustainable level of visibility, which for some people is a single thoughtful LinkedIn comment a month, not a content calendar. The goal is intentional presence, not forced activity.

Q3. What if my honest reputation feedback (FIRST B9) doesn't match how I see myself?

A: That gap is genuinely useful information, not a verdict on your worth. Sit with it rather than dismissing it or spiraling — sometimes it reveals a real blind spot, and sometimes the other person's view is simply incomplete. Either way, it's worth taking seriously rather than ignoring.

Q4. I found something concerning when I searched my own name for the Digital Footprint Audit (B16) — what do I do?

A: Talk to your facilitator privately rather than raising it in the group. Depending on what it is, there may be a straightforward removal request, a way to push newer, more positive content higher in search results, or simply a need to be ready to address it directly if it comes up in an interview.

Q5. What if I genuinely hate how I sound or look on camera?

A: Almost everyone feels this way the first time. The goal of FIRSTS B26 and B27 isn't to make you love watching yourself — it's to catch specific, fixable habits (filler words, poor lighting, reading visibly off a script) that are invisible without seeing the recording.

Q6. Is a personal website (FIRST B17) genuinely necessary for every field?

A: No — it's most valuable in creative, technical, and entrepreneurial fields where a portfolio of work matters more than a resume alone. For other fields, a strong LinkedIn profile and resume may be sufficient, though a simple site never hurts.

Q7. What if the job listing I want to tailor my resume against (FIRST B35) closes before I finish?

A: That's fine — the listing is a tool for practicing tailoring, not necessarily the exact job you'll apply to. The skill of matching your resume to a specific posting's language and priorities transfers directly to the next real listing you find.